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$4.00 | WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 11, 2026 | CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Jordan elected House GOP leader

Amid party fracture in wake of sweeping election losses, controversial Trump ally rises to leadership

By Michael Gold
THE NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — Divided House Republicans elected Rep. Jim Jordan of Ohio to be their leader Tuesday, elevating a pugilistic firebrand who has been a close ally of President Donald Trump as they reel from a crushing defeat in the midterm elections.

Jordan, the current chairman of the Judiciary Committee, will replace Speaker Mike Johnson next year, when Republicans are relegated to the minority and effectively shut out of power. He will inherit a fractious and diminished conference that was already plagued by bitter infighting before it lost control of the House.

Jordan, 62, who was elected in a closed-door party meeting, will play a critical role in his party's efforts to chart a path back to the majority. He will also lead Republicans' efforts to shield Trump and his administration from an anticipated barrage of investigations and oversight efforts from House Democrats.

See **JORDAN** on Page A6



Rep. Jim Jordan arrives for a House Republican Conference meeting Tuesday at the Capitol in Washington. **ALEX WONG/GETTY**

NATION & WORLD

House nixes bid to oust Hegseth



The House on Tuesday turned aside a resolution to impeach Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth, halting an effort to remove the Pentagon chief for his conduct in office and his handling of the Iran war. The effort may reemerge in 2027, when Democrats take control. **Page B4**

"It's just a weird feeling, an eerie feeling sitting here and waiting for these people to release her, even though we did everything right."

CLAUDIA SIEMIONKOWICZ, whose mother had been detained by ICE since August 2025



'SHE'S SAFE NOW'

After 15 months in Kentucky, Round Lake woman released from ICE custody, reunites with daughters

By Allison Kiehl and Armando L. Sanchez
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A Round Lake mother and green card holder who had been in ICE custody for more than a year in Kentucky was heading home after a federal judge ruled Friday that her time spent in detention "had become unreasonably prolonged and violated her due process rights."

U.S. District Judge Angelica Powers of the Memphis Immigration Court in Memphis, Tennessee, released Beata Siemionkowicz on bond, allowing the 57-year-old Polish citizen to return to the Chicago area and reunite with her daughters, Gabi, 22, and Claudia, 26.

Her daughters drove to Kentucky early Monday to pick up their mother from Campbell County Detention Center, where she'd been detained since August 2025. Then they sat in the detention center's parking lot for more than 24 hours, waiting for the moment their mom would walk out the front door.

"It's just a weird feeling, an eerie feeling sitting here and waiting for these people to release her, even though we did everything right," Claudia Siemionkowicz said, sitting in the jail parking lot.

Just before 12:30 p.m. Central Time, Beata Siemionkowicz walked into her daughters' tearful embrace outside of the Campbell County Detention Facility for the first time in more than a year. Claudia told the Tribune that the first thing she wants to tell her mom is that she is safe. Free.

"She's safe now; everything is going to be OK," the 26-year-old said. "We are going to fight her case from the outside of these walls. We are taking her home to be comfortable, to make her feel like herself again."

Siemionkowicz told her daughters that she looks forward to taking a long, hot shower and sleeping in her own bed — not on a metal bunk.

Siemionkowicz's ordeal began the afternoon of Aug. 2, 2025, when two masked ICE agents in civilian clothes arrested her while she was gardening in her daughter's backyard in Des Plaines.

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Beata Siemionkowicz, center, hugs her daughters, Gabi, right, and Claudia after being released from Campbell County Detention Center on Tuesday in Newport, Kentucky. Siemionkowicz, a green card holder from Poland, has been in ICE custody since being detained in Claudia's Des Plaines backyard while gardening last year in August. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Aldermen left in dark on gunshot detection

Johnson's decision to alter plan has foes scouring for answers

By Jake Sheridan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

As aldermen grilled Mayor Brandon Johnson's top procurement official for abruptly changing the mayor's vague plan to test gunshot detection technology in Chicago neighborhoods, they were left without a key piece of information.

Before his administration backed off the small-scale pilot program the mayor had been promising would start in early November, it faced legal pressure from SoundThinking, the company behind the controversial ShotSpotter gunshot detection system Johnson decommissioned two years ago.

City Chief Procurement Officer Sharla Roberts announced to aldermen Monday the administration would abandon its imminent trial of an unnamed gunshot detection tool and instead test a variety of such technology.

"We are in the process of reviewing the pathway that we're going to take, so it will be a pilot. But we're opening up to a broader base," she said during a hearing on the 2027 budget.

The news stunned City Council members, who became irate and confused as Roberts shared few details on what will come next.

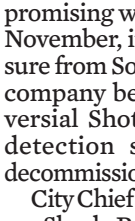
The procurement leader had

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CHICAGOLAND

Helping veterans find new purpose

A Naperville-based nonprofit helps veterans develop skills so they can start or own a business. **Page A6**



MANAGER OF THE YEAR: Venable wins A.L. honors for Sox turnaround. **Sports**

Prosecutors: $503 transaction followed killing of anti-violence activist

By Caroline Kubzansky
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The CEO of a South Side community violence intervention organization was shot to death in a plot connected to someone he knew from work, Cook County prosecutors alleged Tuesday.

"Work" for 57-year-old Andre Thomas was leading Integrity and Fidelity NFP, a violence prevention and street outreach organization based in Chicago's Englewood neighborhood. Thomas was sitting in his car outside the group's office in Chicago Heights on Halloween night when two men approached his car and one started shooting in what appeared to be a pre-planned attack, authorities have said.

Prosecutors said Tuesday that one of the assailants, who has not yet been charged, withdrew $503 from an ATM shortly after the shooting and appeared to hand it over to Alex Morris, who is charged with firing on Thomas. Morris, 54, appeared for a detention hearing at the Markham courthouse early Tuesday afternoon. He faces a single count of first degree murder.

It took most of the morning for

See **KILLING** on Page A7

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